MZUZU UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS

COMM 1101: COMMUNICATION SKILLS I

DATE: Wednesday, April 21, 2021 **TIME: 2 HOURS**

(2:00-4:00 P.M.)

Instruction: Answer **all** questions

QUESTION 1

Study the figure below and answer the questions that follow:

I._____ II._____ III._____ IV._____

A. List the elements of the communication process represented by I, II, III, and IV in the figure above. **(4marks)**

B. Why is step **IV above** important in the communication process? **(2 marks)**

C. Which communication theory best describes the above figure? Justify your answer. **(4 marks)**

QUESTION 2

Imagine you have been chosen to present a topic on how to enforce COVID-19 guidelines to your fellow students in the Auditorium at Mzuzu University. It will be your first time to make a presentation before a large audience. Describe how you as a speaker would use each of the following examples of non-verbal communication in your speech. Provide an example in each case.

I. Facial expressions **(3 marks)**
II. Eye contact **(3 marks)**
III. Posture **(3 marks)**

QUESTION 3

A. State any **two** points why it is important to consider your purpose when reading. **(2 marks)**
B. Using **one** example in each case, distinguish between denotative and connotative meanings. **(4 marks)**
C. Imagine you have been assigned to carry out a critical reading exercise. Briefly explain any **two** factors that you would use in order to read critically. **(4 marks)**

QUESTION 4

Read the text below and make notes. **(10 marks)**

We will now talk about the social construction of inequality. To speak of being privileged in some ways and disadvantaged in others does not mean I take either for granted. The fact that my sex makes me vulnerable to job discrimination, violence, and other injustices is not something I accept as unchangeable. In fact, one reason I wrote this book is because I believe we can bring about changes in our society. I also do not accept my privileges without reflection. The realisation that both my personal life and my professional life are contoured by whether I fit what our culture arbitrarily designates as normal or superior makes me keenly aware that sex, gender, race, sexual identity, and class profoundly influence individuals' knowledge, experience, and opportunities (Andersen & Collins, 2007b).

If we don't want to be limited by the horizon of our social position, we can learn about the experiences, perspectives, and circumstances of people in other social positions: the anger and hurt experienced by transgendered people in a society that defines heterosexuality as the only normal, acceptable sexual identity; the resentment felt by some

heterosexual white men toward laws and policies that could reduce the privileges they enjoy; what it means to be a person of color in a sea of whiteness; the sense of restriction many women feel knowing they cannot venture out at night without risking assault; the frustration felt by poor and working-class citizens whose needs and circumstances often are not represented in legislation that claims to help everyone.

We cannot fully understand the lives of people who differ from us. Sensitivity and earnest efforts to understand are important, yet they cannot yield complete knowledge of the daily reality of others' lives. But we can realize that our feelings, identities, values, and perspectives are not everyone's. Recognising the limits of our own perspective and experiences encourages us to learn from people who have different perspectives and experiences. We do this by respecting the specific conditions that shape their lives and by recognizing that only they can define the meanings of their experiences, feelings, thoughts, hopes, beliefs, problems, and needs. We cannot speak for them, cannot appropriate their voices as our own. But to listen is to learn, and to learn is to broaden our appreciation of the range of human experiences and possibilities.

Realising that inequality is socially constructed empowers us to be agents of change. We can choose whether to accept our culture's designations of who is valuable and who is not, what is normal and what is not. We don't have to treat light skin, heterosexuality, maleness, and middle-class economic status as superior or normal or right. Instead, if we choose to, we can challenge social views that accord arbitrary and unequal value to people and that limit humans' opportunities and lives.

QUESTION 5

Carefully examine the following information and answer the questions that follow:

The book *Communication Skills* was written by D. Orlich, R. Harder, R. Callaha, C. Kravas, R. Pendergras, and A. Keogh. It was published in 2014 by John Willey & Sons in Massachusetts.

A. Assuming you have used the book above in your essay, briefly explain how you would cite it in your text using the APA style of parenthetical citation:

   i. The first time you use it **(2 marks)**
   ii. The second time you use it. **(2 marks)**

B. Provide the bibliographic entry of the book. **(4 marks)**

C. Using an example in each case, briefly explain when an ampersand (&) and 'and' should be used when using APA style of parenthetical citation. **(4 marks)**

QUESTION 6

Read the text below and answer the questions that follow:

The end of 2019 shall be remembered as they year when the first case of COVID-19 was found in China. The pandemic has killed many people, disrupted the normal way of life for example schools and churches have had to close and it has also adversely affected the global economy. In Malawi more than 1, 128 people have died and the number is expected to rise.

A. Write a thesis statement using the above information. **(2 marks)**

B. Using the above thesis statement in **A**, write an introductory paragraph of an essay. **(4 marks)**

C. What kind of approach have you used to write the above introduction? Justify your answer. **(3 marks)**

END OF QUESTION PAPER